

DAILY NEED TO KNOW

Friday, 24 July 2026 · Pre-market brief for Anne Wong

Covering the Thursday 23 July 2026 US session + overnight. All times GMT+8 (HKT).

Edition: FULL — Hedgeye logged-in edition (live risk ranges & Quads).

1 Market snapshot (Thu 23 Jul close)

Asset	Last		Change	Note
S&P 500	7,408.30	▼	- 90.66 / -1.21%	Risk-off; oil shock + AI-capex fears; closed just below Hedgeye 7,420
Nasdaq Composite	25,137.69	▼	- 553.21 / -2.15%	Led lower; chip/AI-capex de-risking into the close
Dow Jones	51,711.65	▼	- 506.93 / -0.97%	Broad decline; defensives cushioned
Russell 2000	~2,935*	▼	≈ -0.8%	Small-caps hit by higher yields; inside 2,926-2,986
US 2Y yield	~4.20%	◆	≈ flat	Broke prior cycle high 4.23%; bullish
US 10Y yield	~4.63%	▲	+ a few bp	Near the 4.67% cycle high; bullish
Gold (spot)	~\$4,108	▼	≈ -0.9%	Pulled back after Wed haven rally; bearish TREND
Silver (spot)	~\$60.0	◆	≈ flat	Held \$60; bearish TREND
WTI crude	~\$89.9	▲	+~3%	Mideast escalation; near Hedgeye top \$91.10
Brent crude	~\$100.65	▲	+~7%	Red Sea tanker attacks; highest in over a year
Bitcoin	~\$65,700	►	≈ flat	Consolidating below \$66k
US Dollar (DXY)	~101.0	◆	≈ firm	Bullish TREND
VIX	~17.8	▲	+~7%	Ticked up but still complacent given the oil shock

Colour key: ▲ up ▼ down ◆ neutral/mixed ► little changed. A rise in yields or VIX is not necessarily good. * = confirm live.

TL;DR: Thursday was a risk-off US session — S&P -1.2%, Nasdaq -2.2%, Dow -1.0% — as a Middle East escalation drove Brent to ~\$100 (+7%) and the 10Y held near its 4.67% cycle high, while Alphabet's \$200bn capex message kept the AI-capex payers under pressure. But after the bell **Intel blew out** (adj EPS \$0.42 vs \$0.21; revenue +25% to \$16.1bn; +12% AH), turbocharging an AI/chip rally and flipping US futures higher into Asia. Hedgeye's Machine confirms Global **#Quad3 reflation** ("Bombs, #Bag7 & Capex Bubbles") — oil, commodities and global yields breaking out together while Bag7 leadership deteriorates and AAPL stands alone as Bullish TREND.

Today's actionable levels — what to watch

- ▼ **S&P 500:** closed 7,408 — just BELOW the Hedgeye 7,420-7,556 range. Reclaiming 7,420 is needed to stabilise; failure keeps the squeeze unwinding toward the low-7,300s.
- ▲ **US 10Y:** ~4.63%, range 4.53-4.71% (bullish). The 4.67% cycle high is the line — a push through it pressures long-duration tech and gold.
- ▲ **WTI:** ~\$90 vs Hedgeye \$80.26-\$91.10. Watch \$91.10 (Red Sea/Hormuz disruption → inflation bid) vs ~\$82 TREND support on any de-escalation. Brent already ~\$100.
- ▼ **VIX:** ~17.8, range 15.57-19.49 (bearish TREND). 19.49 flips the regime; sub-18 is complacent given a live oil/Iran tail into the 28-29 Jul FOMC.
- ◆ **Gold:** ~\$4,108 vs \$3,976-\$4,149 (bearish TREND). \$4,149 is the ceiling; holding >\$4,080 keeps it constructive, a loss re-opens \$3,976.

2 The big picture — what it means

- The oil shock is the new macro driver.** Brent ripped ~+7% to ~\$100 and WTI to ~\$90 after Houthi strikes on two Saudi tankers in the Red Sea, renewed US strikes on Iran and a Kazakh halt to CPC exports. This is the #Quad3 reflation catalyst — inflation re-accelerating while growth decelerates — and it kept the 10Y pinned near its 4.67% cycle high. Energy is the leadership; oil-importers (Japan, Korea, India) wear the cost.
- Big Tech's AI-capex bill is still the equity worry.** Alphabet's \$195-205bn 2026 capex guide and first negative-FCF quarter continued to weigh on the capex payers Thursday, dragging the Nasdaq -2.2%. Hedgeye's read: Bag7 leadership is breaking down — GOOGL, TSLA, MSFT, AMZN, META and NVDA are all deteriorating on TREND; only AAPL holds a clean Bullish TRADE + TREND.
- Intel just re-lit the AI-infrastructure trade.** After the bell Intel crushed it (adj EPS \$0.42 vs \$0.21; revenue +25% to \$16.1bn — its fastest growth in ~15 years; Data Center & AI +59% to \$6.3bn; upbeat Q3 guide) and jumped ~12%. Chipmakers hit fresh highs and futures turned up — a direct read-through to the memory/HBM complex (SK Hynix, Samsung, Micron) and TSMC into the Asia open.
- Central banks are turning on oil, not growth.** The ECB held at 2.25% (unanimous) but Lagarde explicitly flagged the Middle East oil spike as an upside inflation risk and left the door open to a September hike — a hawkish hold. That reinforces higher-for-longer into the 28-29 Jul FOMC and keeps the reflation/duration trade intact.

3 Rates, currencies & commodities

- Rates:** 2Y ~4.20% broke its prior 4.23% cycle high (bullish, Alpha Code 4.16/4.02); 10Y ~4.63% nearing the 4.67% cycle high (Alpha 4.52/4.44); the German Bund 10Y broke its May highs (~3.18%). The process remains out of Treasuries (TLT) and IG credit (LQD 106.3-107.8, bearish).

- **US Dollar:** DXY ~101.0, firm and bullish TREND (100.48–101.59) — a reflation-plus-haven bid.
- **Oil:** WTI ~\$90 (range \$80.26–\$91.10, bullish, Alpha Code 7982); Brent ~\$100.65 (+7%). Red Sea tanker attacks, a declared Saudi-port blockade and a Kazakh CPC halt are the live spike catalysts; the Strait of Hormuz remains stressed.
- **Broad reflation:** Copper bullish (6.15–6.55); wheat +20% and European gas +51% over the past month; natural gas bearish (2.79–3.05). The commodity tape corroborates #Quad3.
- **Precious metals:** Gold ~\$4,108 and silver ~\$60 pulled back after Wednesday's haven rally on a firm dollar and higher yields — both still sit on a bearish Hedgeye TREND (gold \$3,976–\$4,149; silver \$55–\$61).

4 Hedgeye Risk Ranges & regime

Regime: Global #Quad3 (reflation) — inflation re-accelerating while growth decelerates. Today's Early Look, "Bombs, #Bag7, & Capex Bubbles" (McCullough): oil's breakout (Alpha 7982) plus rising 2/10/30yr yields confirm reflation, while the Bag7 breaks down. The Signalling Process is short #Bag7 momentum via XLK/PTF and hedging Long Cybersecurity Software (BUG); Portfolio Solutions' ETF re-rank flagged XLRE (+6), NOBL (+5) and BUG (+4) as top movers. Immediate-term ranges (TREND = intermediate signal):

Instrument	Immediate-term risk range	TREND
S&P 500 (SPX)	7,420 – 7,556	Bullish
Nasdaq Composite (COMPQ)	25,208 – 25,994	Bullish
Russell 2000 (RUT)	2,926 – 2,986	Bullish
US 10Y yield	4.53 – 4.71%	Bullish
US Dollar (DXY)	100.48 – 101.59	Bullish
WTI crude	\$80.26 – \$91.10	Bullish
Gold	\$3,976 – \$4,149	Bearish
Silver	\$55 – \$61	Bearish
Copper	\$6.15 – \$6.55	Bullish
VIX	15.57 – 19.49	Bearish
HY credit (HYG)	79.40 – 79.81	Neutral
IG credit (LQD)	106.3 – 107.8	Bearish
Tech (XLK)	\$171 – \$186	Neutral
Health Care (XLV)	\$157 – \$163	Bullish
Utilities (XLU)	\$44.44 – \$46.20	Bullish
Real Estate (XLRE)	\$44.22 – \$45.66	Bullish

Where price sits in its 52-week range

S&P 500 L 5,921  H 7,621 • last 7,408 (87%)
Nasdaq L 18,900  H 27,190 • last 25,138 (75%)
Dow L 41,600  H 52,700 • last 51,712 (91%)
WTI L \$58  H \$92 • last \$89.9 (94%)
Gold L \$2,780  H \$4,167 • last \$4,108 (96%)

Where we sit: S&P upper-third but pierced its Hedgeye low; Nasdaq mid-upper and de-rating on capex; 10Y near the cycle high; gold near highs but bearish TREND; VIX mid-range, bearish.

5 Mag7 scoreboard

Name	Last		Day	Cap	Read
Nvidia (NVDA)	~\$207*	◆	noisy	~\$5.0T	@Hedgeye TREND 207; HBM demand the tell
Apple (AAPL)	\$333*	▲	lone leader	~\$4.9T	Only Bag7 name w/ Bullish TRADE + TREND (Hedgeye)
Microsoft (MSFT)	~\$395*	▼	softer	~\$3.0T	Failed to hold Bullish TREND again; reports next wk
Alphabet (GOOGL)	\$356*	▼	weak	~\$4.3T	\$200bn '26 capex + neg-FCF qtr overhang
Amazon (AMZN)	~\$248*	◆	at support	~\$2.7T	Sitting on @Hedgeye TREND support; reports next wk
Meta (META)	~\$650*	▼	softer	~\$1.7T	TREND Signal in play again (\$621 line)
Tesla (TSLA)	~\$385*	▼	bearish	~\$1.5T	"Dumpster fire"; Bearish TRADE + TREND (Hedgeye)

* Prices are last confirmed cash close (or prior/delayed); Hedgeye TRADE/TREND signals as of the 23 Jul Early Look. Confirm live before acting.

6 Positioning & options

- **VIX:** ~17.8 (+~7%) — ticked up on the oil shock but still complacent; range 15.57–19.49, bearish TREND. 19.49 is the level that flips the regime.

- **Two-sided into the open:** Intel's +12% AH argues for a chip-led bounce at the cash open, but the S&P closing below its Hedgeye 7,420 floor and a live oil/Iran tail argue for two-way risk.
- **Net read:** Reflation is priced with credit still calm (HYG 79.40–79.81, neutral) — a tape re-pricing capex discipline and an oil premium, not a broad scare. Watch VIX reclaiming 19.49 or HYG cracking 79.40. (Live add: CBOE put/call, CNN Fear & Greed.)

7 Sector rotation — leaders & laggards

- **Leaders:** Energy/oil & oil services, defensives (utilities XLU, real estate XLRE bullish), aerospace/defense (Honeywell +4.7%), semis after the bell (Intel +12% AH), and materials on the commodity breakout.
- **Laggards:** Mega-cap AI-capex payers (GOOGL, MSFT, META, NVDA), telecom (T-Mobile –6.6% on soft adds), small-caps (Russell, on yields) and long-duration bonds (TLT) / IG credit (LQD).
- **Rotation read:** Leadership is rotating toward reflation (oil, copper, metals), defensives and the AI pick-and-shovel, and away from richly-valued capex payers — classic #Quad3 behaviour.

8 Forward — futures & the week ahead

- **Futures (as Asia opens):** US futures turned higher, led by the Nasdaq-100, as Intel's blowout re-lit the AI/chip trade — a rebound attempt after Thursday's cash-session sell-off.

Day	Key events
Thu 23	Reported: Intel (blowout, +12% AH), Honeywell (+4.7%), T-Mobile (–6.6%), Thermo Fisher, Blackstone. ECB held at 2.25% (Lagarde hawkish).
Fri 24	★ S&P Global flash PMIs (Jul); New Home Sales (Jun); earnings: American Express, Charter, HCA, Aon (BMO).
Next wk	★ FOMC 28–29 Jul · BoJ 30 Jul · China Politburo (stimulus) late Jul · MSFT, META, AAPL, AMZN report.

9 Corporate news

- **Intel:** Adj EPS \$0.42 vs \$0.21 est; revenue \$16.1bn (+25%, fastest in ~15 yrs); Data Center & AI +59% to \$6.3bn; Q3 guide \$15.8–16.8bn vs \$15.06bn est. Stock +~12% AH to ~\$113 (had been +163% YTD).
- **Honeywell:** +4.7%. EPS \$1.95 beat \$1.80; raised FY adjusted-EPS guide on strong aerospace & defense demand.
- **T-Mobile:** –6.6% despite EPS \$2.99 vs \$2.58 — soft postpaid net-add outlook and FCF-margin compression on higher capex/marketing.
- **Alphabet / Tesla (carryover):** GOOGL's \$200bn '26 capex + first neg-FCF quarter and TSLA's EPS miss continued to pressure the Bag7 through Thursday.

10 Macro data

- **US:** No first-tier release Thursday; ~88% of S&P 500 reporters beating EPS. The oil spike complicates the disinflation path and keeps rate expectations two-sided into the 28–29 Jul FOMC. Fri: S&P Global flash PMIs + New Home Sales.
- **Europe:** ECB held at 2.25% (unanimous); eurozone inflation 2.8%, GDP ~0.8%. Lagarde flagged the Middle East oil spike as an upside inflation risk and left a September hike on the table — a hawkish hold. Bund yields broke May highs.
- **China:** LPRs at record lows; the late-July Politburo is the stimulus catalyst.
- **Japan:** BoJ policy 30 Jul; the yen and rate path remain the Nikkei's swing factor — and a \$100 oil bill is a fresh headwind for the import-heavy economy.

11 Geopolitics

- **Red Sea / Saudi tankers:** Houthi militants claimed strikes on two Saudi oil tankers and declared a blockade of Saudi ports — the proximate driver of the ~7% Brent spike to ~\$100.
- **Iran / Strait of Hormuz:** Renewed US strikes on Iran and continued vessel attacks in Hormuz keep transit highly stressed; any tanker-disruption headline is the next spike catalyst.
- **Kazakhstan / CPC:** Kazakhstan halted crude exports through the Caspian Pipeline Consortium terminal after drone attacks — a second, non-Gulf supply shock layered on top.

12 Asia setup — today (Fri 24 Jul, pre-open)

Index	Level / move	Read
US futures	▲ higher	Nasdaq-100 futures jumped as Intel (+12% AH) turbocharged the AI/chip rally
Nikkei 225	▲ set firm	Chip complex to lead on Intel + memory read-through (pre-open)
Kospi (Korea)	▲ set firm	SK Hynix & Samsung the engine on the AI-capex/HBM tell (pre-open)
Topix	◆ mixed	Energy/materials bid vs oil-import cost drag (pre-open)
Hang Seng	◆ ≈ steady	Awaiting the late-July Politburo stimulus signal
CSI 300	◆ ≈ steady	LPRs at record lows; Politburo the catalyst
S&P/ASX 200	▲ set firm	Energy & materials firm on the oil/commodity breakout

Read: This brief lands pre-open (07:15 GMT+8) — levels are futures/indications, not cash. The pivot is Intel's after-hours blowout re-lighting the AI/chip complex (SK Hynix, Samsung, TSMC) against a risk-off US cash close and a \$100 oil bill that penalises import-heavy Japan/Korea. Watch whether the chip bounce holds through the cash opens and whether the next Red Sea/Hormuz headline extends the oil premium.

13 AI watch

- **Intel resets the tape:** Data Center & AI +59% to \$6.3bn and 25% total revenue growth argue the physical AI build-out is still accelerating — a bullish read-through to foundry, HBM and AI-PC demand.
- **Capex vs cash:** Alphabet's \$195–205bn '26 capex and negative FCF keep the market interrogating whether hyperscaler AI spend converts to cash — the dispersion trade between capex payers and pick-and-shovel beneficiaries. MSFT/META/AMZN prints next week are the tell.
- **Memory supercycle:** Bigger hyperscaler + Intel demand is bullish HBM/DDR5 — SK Hynix, Samsung and Micron are the pick-and-shovel into the Asia open.

14 Beyond the markets

- **Energy security:** Multiple simultaneous supply shocks (Red Sea, Hormuz, Kazakh CPC) put energy-security and shipping-insurance costs back on the agenda for Asian importers.
- **Weather (market-moving):** A European heatwave continues to stress the EU corn/maize belt and power grid — watch grains, softs and European gas (up ~51% on the month).
- **Water cooler:** Tour de France in its final week; MLB in full swing; a strong summer box office remains a tailwind for exhibitors.

15 Appendix — stock cards

Every name mentioned above plus the top global names — last + day · market cap · valuation · next key date · one-line read. Prices are 23 Jul cash close unless flagged * (prior close / delayed / after-hours). No charts.

US — movers & mega-caps

Intel (INTC)

~\$113* ▲ +12% AH
Cap ~\$0.5T Val turnaround
Next: Reported 23 Jul (AMC)
Blowout: adj EPS \$0.42 vs \$0.21; rev +25% to \$16.1bn; DC&AI +59%.

Apple (AAPL)

\$333* ▲ leader
Cap ~\$4.9T Val P/E ~33
Next: Reports late Jul/Aug
Lone Bag7 name w/ clear Bullish TRADE + TREND.

Microsoft (MSFT)

~\$395* ▼ softer
Cap ~\$3.0T Val P/E ~36
Next: Reports next wk
Failed Bullish TREND again; Azure capex in focus.

Meta (META)

~\$650* ▼ softer
Cap ~\$1.7T Val P/E ~27
Next: Reports next wk
TREND in play again (\$621); AI-capex scrutiny.

Honeywell (HON)

firm* ▲ +4.7%
Cap ~\$0.14T Val P/E ~22
Next: Reported 23 Jul
EPS \$1.95 beat \$1.80; raised FY guide; aero/defense strong.

Super Micro (SMCI)

~\$31* ▲ firm
Cap ~\$0.02T Val cyclical
Next: Reported 22 Jul
\$60bn+ orders incl. a SpaceX AI data centre.

Nvidia (NVDA)

~\$207* ◆ —
Cap ~\$5.0T Val P/E ~32
Next: Reports late Aug
AI bellwether; @Hedgeye TREND 207; HBM the tell.

Alphabet (GOOGL)

\$356* ▼ weak
Cap ~\$4.3T Val P/E ~24
Next: Reported 22 Jul
\$200bn '26 capex + first neg-FCF qtr; TREND broke.

Amazon (AMZN)

~\$248* ◆ at support
Cap ~\$2.7T Val P/E ~38
Next: Reports next wk
On @Hedgeye TREND support; AWS the key line.

Tesla (TSLA)

~\$385* ▼ bearish
Cap ~\$1.5T Val rich
Next: Reported 22 Jul
Adj EPS 33c miss; Bearish TRADE + TREND (Hedgeye).

T-Mobile (TMUS)

soft* ▼ -6.6%
Cap ~\$0.24T Val P/E ~22
Next: Reported 23 Jul
EPS \$2.99 beat but soft postpaid adds / FCF squeeze.

Micron (MU)

firm* ▲ memory bid
Cap ~\$0.2T Val cyclical
Next: Reports late Sep
HBM/DDR5 leader; core of the memory supercycle.

Europe — top 6

ASML (ASML)

\$1,740* ◆ —
Cap ~\$670B Val P/E ~55
Next: Reported ~21 Jul
AI-litho monopoly; capex read-through to memory.

Shell (SHEL)

firm* ▲ w/ oil
Cap ~\$225B Val P/E ~11
Next: Reports end-Jul
Prime beneficiary of the Hormuz/Red Sea premium.

TotalEnergies (TTE)

SAP (SAP)

\$158* ◆ —
Cap ~\$185B Val P/E ~22
Next: Reported ~21 Jul
EU software bellwether; cloud backlog the watch.

Novo Nordisk (NVO)

\$49* ◆ —
Cap ~\$218B Val P/E ~12
Next: Reports early Aug
Cheap; GLP-1 competition the overhang.

LVMH (MC.PA)

firm* ▲ w/ oil Cap ~\$150B Val P/E ~9 <i>Next: Reports end-Jul</i> Energy leverage into the oil breakout.	n/a ◆ — Cap ~\$350B Val P/E ~22 <i>Next: Reported recently</i> Luxury bellwether; China demand the swing.
---	---

Asia ex-China — top 6 (live / most-recent)

TSMC (2330 / TSM) \$405* ▲ chip bid Cap ~\$1.9T Val P/E ~27 <i>Next: Reported 16 Jul</i> Region anchor; Intel print reinforces AI demand.	SK Hynix (000660) firm* ▲ HBM Cap mega-cap Val cyclical <i>Next: Reports late Jul</i> HBM4 leader; Kospi engine on the AI-capex read.
Samsung Elec (005930) firm* ▲ memory Cap mega-cap Val P/E ~14 <i>Next: Reports late Jul</i> AI-memory leverage; core of the Kospi bid.	Sony (6758) n/a ◆ — Cap ~¥20T Val P/E ~20 <i>Next: Reports Aug</i> Games/imaging; steady.
SoftBank (9984) firm* ◆ — Cap large-cap Val NAV <i>Next: Reports Aug</i> AI/portfolio proxy (Arm, OpenAI exposure).	Kioxia (285A) firm* ▲ NAND Cap large-cap Val cyclical <i>Next: Reports Aug</i> NAND maker; rides the memory complex.

China — top 6 (live / most-recent)

Alibaba (9988 / BABA) \$120* ▲ ADR firm Cap ~\$274B Val P/E ~18 <i>Next: Reports mid-Aug</i> AI re-rating on Qwen; strongest China story.	Baidu (9888 / BIDU) n/a* ◆ — Cap ~\$40B Val P/E ~11 <i>Next: Reports Aug</i> AI/robotaxi optimism; watch the Politburo.
Xiaomi (1810) HK\$26* ◆ — Cap ~HK\$664B Val P/E ~30 <i>Next: Reports Aug</i> Strong EV deliveries; off highs.	Kweichow Moutai (600519) firm* ◆ — Cap ~¥1.6T Val P/E ~20 <i>Next: Reports Aug</i> Consumer-luxury proxy; off highs.
BYD (1211) n/a ◆ — Cap ~HK\$900B Val P/E ~18 <i>Next: Reports late Aug</i> EV leader; delivery momentum the driver.	Meituan (3690) n/a ◆ — Cap ~HK\$800B Val P/E ~20 <i>Next: Reports Aug</i> Local services; margin recovery watch.

Sources: Index closes & narrative: CNBC, Yahoo Finance, Washington Post, Bloomberg (23 Jul). Earnings: FXLeaders, TradingKey, Yahoo, Benzinga, MarketScreener (INTC, HON, TMUS). Rates/commodities/FX/crypto: Trading Economics, Vantage, Forbes, NBC News, CoinDesk. Macro/central banks: CNBC, Bloomberg, Central Banking, Euronews (ECB). Risk ranges, Alpha Codes & Quads: Hedgeye Early Look "Bombs, #Bag7, & Capex Bubbles" (logged-in FULL edition, 23 Jul).

Data-confidence: Thu 23 Jul US index closes confirmed & cross-checked (CNBC/Yahoo/WaPo): S&P 7,408.30 (−1.21%), Nasdaq 25,137.69 (−2.15%), Dow 51,711.65 (−0.97%). Commodities/yields/VIX are late-session/near-close reads (flagged ~). Russell 2000 and several mega-cap/Europe/Asia/China card prices are prior-close, delayed or after-hours (flagged *) — verify live before acting. Brief generated 07:15 GMT+8, pre-Asia-open, so Asia levels are futures/indications. This is the FULL Hedgeye edition (logged-in browser reachable).